

Procurement Policy

Enterprise purchasing framework for goods, services, suppliers and contracts

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1. Purpose and Policy Statement

MedCore maintains a controlled procurement process to obtain goods and services that meet operational, clinical, quality, financial, security and compliance requirements.

Procurement decisions should be transparent, appropriately approved, commercially reasonable and supported by documented evidence. No employee may commit MedCore to a supplier outside the approved purchasing process.

2. Scope

This policy applies to procurement of medical and non-medical supplies, equipment, services, software, facilities support, professional services and other third-party purchases made on behalf of MedCore.

3. Procurement Principles

Use approved suppliers and competitive sourcing where appropriate to the value, risk and urgency of the purchase.

Separate requesting, approval and purchasing responsibilities where practical.

Evaluate suppliers using objective requirements and retain the basis for material sourcing decisions.

Manage conflicts of interest and disclose any personal or financial relationship with a prospective supplier.

Do not split purchases into smaller transactions to bypass approval thresholds.

4. Procurement Categories and Risk

Category	Examples	Typical control emphasis
Clinical / medical	Devices, consumables, laboratory supplies	Quality, regulatory suitability, service continuity
Operational	Housekeeping, maintenance, facilities	Service scope, SLA, price, continuity
Technology	Software, hardware, cloud services	Security, privacy, licensing, integration
Professional services	Consulting, legal, specialist services	Scope, credentials, conflicts, deliverables
Capital equipment	Major equipment and installations	Business case, technical evaluation, approvals

5. Sourcing and Quotation Requirements

For material purchases, Procurement should obtain quotations or proposals from an appropriate number of qualified suppliers unless a documented exception applies.

Single-source or emergency procurement requires documented justification, approval at the applicable authority level and, where appropriate, a subsequent market review.

Commercial comparisons should consider total cost of ownership, not only the quoted purchase price.

6. Purchase Orders and Contracting

A purchase order or approved contract should be issued before a supplier begins work or ships goods, except where an approved emergency process applies.

Contracts should clearly identify scope, pricing, delivery or service levels, responsibilities, confidentiality requirements and applicable termination or renewal terms.

7. Supplier Management

Suppliers may be subject to onboarding checks, financial or operational assessment, references, compliance declarations, information-security review and other due diligence based on risk.

Material supplier performance should be monitored against agreed delivery, quality, service and commercial measures. Significant or repeated issues should be escalated and documented.

8. Conflicts of Interest and Ethical Conduct

Employees involved in supplier selection must disclose relevant conflicts and must not accept improper benefits, inducements or gifts intended to influence a procurement decision.

Supplier interactions must remain professional and traceable. Suspected misconduct should be reported through the applicable compliance channel.

9. Emergency Procurement

Emergency procurement may be used when delay could materially affect patient care, safety, critical operations or essential infrastructure.

The requester must document the reason, supplier selected, value, approvals and subsequent regularization requirements.

10. Records, Monitoring and Review

Procurement records should include the request, approvals, quotations or sourcing rationale, evaluation, purchase order or contract, supplier documentation and material performance records.

Procurement reviews this policy at least annually and after significant changes to approval thresholds, supplier-risk requirements or operating processes.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can a department directly place an order with a supplier?

Only where the purchase falls within an approved process and the required authority has been obtained. Procurement should be involved according to the applicable category and threshold.

When is single-source procurement acceptable?

When a documented business reason exists, such as compatibility, proprietary capability, continuity or a genuine emergency, with the required approval.

Can the cheapest supplier automatically be selected?

No. Evaluation should consider the approved requirements, quality, delivery, risk, service and total cost, not price alone.